Ask the tutor

A tutor that has read the course's notes and nothing else — answers with its sources shown, checked — and how to interrogate any AI well. Then Graham and Carver, side by side.

We grade decisions, not outcomes.

Education, not advice.

0:00 — HARVEST

The question you brought

Round the room

Each student reads their question aloud. On the board, three columns as they come: the course can answer this · the course cannot · not sure.

Say nothing yet

The hour decides the sorting. By 0:40 the room will know which column each question belongs in, and why.

Tonight

What the tutor is and is not; ask it live and check it; the five habits of asking an AI well; then the gate — Graham and Carver read side by side, and what it said the first night.

An answer with a citation you can check is a claim. An answer without one is a rumour.

Five facts about the page

It has read the notes	the ten lesson plans, the two week-5 segments, the four kit documents — the student's sections, about 160 passages. Not the internet, not the news, not your account, not tonight's prices.
It finds passages by words	“how is the stop calculated?” → stop, calculated → the passages that use them most (stemmed). Ask in the course's words; other words find nothing, and it says so.
It answers from them only, and cites	[L8.9]: lesson 8, passage 9, on every paragraph. Click the tag; the passage is on the page below the answer.
It is checked	a passage it was not given → flagged · a number in no passage it read → flagged · a tip (buy, sell, should, undervalued, a target) → the answer is withheld and the passages shown.
It is anonymous and rationed	no code asked; the question and the outcome are kept so the class can see what was asked; sixty a day on the course's key, then the passages only.

The citations are not decoration. They are the whole point.

0:25 — ASK IT, LIVE

Find the sentence, find the number

Three from the gold set

Projected, each checked by a pair: open the citation, find the claim in the passage, find the number. “The stop gap is ½ × instrument risk × entry: $31.72 on $348.91” — is $31.72 there?

Three of the room's own

From the board's first column. Then — on purpose — “Should I buy Coca-Cola?”: a decline, or an answer in process terms with no tip; if it slips, the page withholds the answer and prints why.

One the notes cannot answer

“How is capital gains tax charged?” The model should say the notes do not cover it (week 11). A confident number here would be the fault to catch.

Hands up for anyone whose answer carried a flag. That is the best homework in the room.

WHAT THE PAGE CATCHES

Three ways an answer can be wrong

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Flagged by the checks: paragraph 1 cites a passage it was not given (P9). Treat that part as unverified.

Flagged by the checks: paragraph 2 has a number that is in none of the passages ($40). Treat that part as unverified.

The AI's answer was withheld by the course's checks (advice-shaped language: “you should buy”). The passages it read are below; the answer is in them.
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An invented source

The model was given six passages, P1–P6, and cited a seventh. The claim may be true; it is unverified, and the page says so.

A number from nowhere

Every figure in the answer must be in a passage it read, to the last digit. $40 is not; the paragraph is marked. The sentence will be fluent either way — the number is where it shows.

A tip

Buy, sell, hold, should, undervalued, a target, a forecast. The answer is withheld; the passages are shown. The course does not say what to buy, and neither does its tutor.

Five habits for asking any AI

1 · Use the source's words	Retrieval matches words. “Instrument risk”, “the stop gap”, “the 12% target”, “the defensive screen” find the course's passages. A general chatbot has the same weakness, dressed better.
2 · One thing at a time	“What is the stop gap, and when does the stop move?” beats “explain stops and sizing and everything”. A long question retrieves the wrong passages and the answer blends them.
3 · Ask for the passage, then read it	Here the page does it for you. Elsewhere: “where does that come from?” — and refuse an answer that cannot say. A source you cannot open is not a source.
4 · Check the number, not the sentence	The sentence will be fluent either way. $31.72 is in the passage or it is not.
5 · Distrust fluency	The better the prose, the more it is worth checking. A confident wrong answer is the product that sells scams. The flags are a training wheel; the habit is the point.

What it cannot know: tonight's prices, your account, tax, anything after the notes were written — and anything about you. A confident answer on those is wrong by construction.

0:55 — THE GATE

Graham says what. Carver says when, and how much.

Graham, first

The screens, from the accounts, slowly: the defensive seven or the enterprising six. A name must pass one — a survivor, or a candidate — to be in the gate at all.

Carver, second

The rule, from prices, nightly: the name must be LONG. Then the Starter System sizes it (12% ÷ N) and the stop closes it. The ticket is yours.

Read together

GATE on the signals page: passes a screen and long. near: one Graham test short and long — a reading list, not a pick. The watchlist says it in sentences, tonight.

The signals page now shows each company's Graham tests passed beside its state: 4/7 · 5/6. Hover for the failed ones.

THE FIRST NIGHT IT WAS READ

6 November 2026: the gate was empty

Nothing passed

No company passed either Graham screen: eight defensive near misses, two enterprising. Every name the rule was long on — nineteen that night — failed both price tests: P/E ≤ 15 and P/B ≤ 1.5.

An empty gate is a result

The rule's answer was cash, and a journal line that says “waiting”. Graham's bars were set in the 1970s; against a 2026 US large-cap market they say “nothing is cheap” — a statement about the market and the bars, not a fault, and not a reason to loosen them tonight (that is a second rule).

The size decides N

A relaxed, labelled example — the longs that passed the most defensive tests, on $10,000: four names failed the 1% round-trip cost rule on two; three worked (DAL 10, JNJ 5, KO 20 — 11.7% of the budget, 58% cash by design). Arithmetic, not a list.

Four instruments on $10,000 is not a bigger portfolio. It is two positions too small to trade.

THE WATCHLIST, IN SENTENCES

Statements about tonight, never a pick

The gate tonight: nothing. No company passes either Graham screen, so there is no name the course would ticket by both rules — the rule's answer is cash, and a journal line that says "waiting".

No near miss is long tonight.

19 names are long on the rule; 19 of them fail both screens. By defensive tests passed, the nearest: … Lesson 10's point: P/E ≤ 15 and P/B ≤ 1.5 are 1970s bars against a 2026 US large-cap market, and the rule does not care.

48 small caps still warming up (fewer than 128 closes); the nearest has … — ticketable once it has 128 and no quarantine.

Four tables

The gate (passes a screen and long) · near misses that are long, with the failed test named · the rule's longs that fail both, by tests passed · small caps on their way to 128 closes.

The 6 Nov shape

Empty, empty, nineteen, forty-eight. The night this deck was written the shape was the same; the counts move nightly — read the page, not the slide.

Still not advice

A name on the page is not a recommendation to buy; an empty gate is not a recommendation to wait. It is what the rules say, written down.

1:10 — LIVE

Your question, tonight

[course URL]/tutor

[course URL]/watchlist

1 · Ask one question in the course's words. Read the answer. Click one tag; find the sentence; find the number. Tell your pair what you found.

2 · If the answer carries a flag, or a claim you cannot find in the passage: write the question and the passage id on the board. The record gets it after class.

3 · Ask one the notes cannot answer. Watch what the page does — the honest “the notes don't cover this” is the behaviour a scam never has.

4 · Open the watchlist. Say the gate's state in one word. Write it in the journal — that is this week's Monday line.

Monday: five minutes, with the watchlist

Monday evening, in this order

/signals for your instrument → your page: the stop, the stamp, the report → the journal → (maybe) a ticket. New: a glance at /watchlist and the gate's state in one word; a question to the tutor before class, with the citation you checked.

1 · Three questions, checked

In the course's words, each with one citation checked: the passage id, the sentence, the number. A flag is the best homework in the room — bring it. 2 · One question the notes cannot answer, and what the page did.

3 · The Monday line · 4 · Week 11

The routine with the watchlist line in the journal. Read the week-11 preview on the ledger; bring your DeGiro questions. No accounts opened.

Close with the sentence: we grade decisions, not outcomes.

GO DEEPER — FREE, FOREVER, OPTIONAL

Where the tutor comes from

The corpus is the repository; the index is a table; the checks are week 6's; the gate is two files you already know:

NOTES docs/lessons/*.md and kit/*.md — the passages the tutor reads are these files, cut by scripts/notes-chunker.mjs; `npm run seed-notes` writes them to the database

INDEX SQLite full-text search (FTS5) in D1 — decision #3; porter stemming; a plain word match when the index is absent (src/lib/tutor.ts, rankByTerms)

CHECKS src/lib/explain.ts — the number check and the advice families of week 6, reused on the answer (checkAnswer); the gold set in docs/lessons/week-10-gold-set.md

GATE src/lib/graham.ts (weeks 4–5) and src/lib/signals.ts (week 7), read together by src/lib/gate.ts — no new rule; the watchlist's sentences in describeWatchlist

PAGE /tutor · /api/tutor · /api/tutor/recent · /watchlist · /api/watchlist · the Graham column on /signals